

Time flies, it saunters, it also stands still

This is **ironic**, **remarked** the gentleman who was being given a send-off party by his office colleagues on his day of retirement. He was looking at the **parting** gift – a shiny, **chunky** wrist watch. “I don’t see myself keeping time in my post-retirement years,” he **mumbled** to me, as I was standing close to him. “A watch is necessary for the working man, to reach office at a certain time, breaking for lunch at a fixed time, leave for home at a **stated** time and so on. But putting my feet up and not watching the clock, is what I most **look forward to**,” he said, smiling broadly. I **concurred** with his **sentiments**; he was a much older colleague and even to me, then in my thirties, his view of time **seemed** logical. I too smiled, and **nodded** my head in **assent**.

Once invited to high tea to a Swiss home, I was **intrigued** that **every room**, bathroom included, **had** a wall clock. Laughing at my quizzical expression, my host said, “Here in Switzerland, we are very **conscious** of keeping time. We expect to keep appointments a few minutes before the stated time,” he said. Switzerland is **renowned** for its watch-making industry as well, and its people are **sticklers** for **punctuality**.

Time-keeping is necessary, especially when we have deadlines to **honour** and time-bound projects to complete. So too, to ensure regularity in our daily activities like waking, eating, working and sleeping. Yet, one cannot help **admit** that often, we become **slaves** of the clock, and miss opportunities to break free of **regimens** to smell the roses, **ruminate**, slip into sakshi bhaav (witness mode) or simply, just be. We are **bewitched** into thinking that time is all for doing, not for being, **points out** Buddhist teacher Susan Moon. Another Buddhist, Wes Nisker, said, “Let us remember that we are called human beings, not human doings.”

Nature of time depends on the context and task **at hand**. My great-grandparents lived in step with nature’s rhythm – as do most species. Sunrise was wake-up time, sunset **signalled** end of day – the **circadian** rhythm. Once we learned to make our own little suns – powerful oil lamps and electricity – we **flouted** natural rhythms. Suddenly, there was more time to read, chat, perform, make music, argue, fight and of course, work, too. Just as **moderation** is good in eating and exercising, it is also good **in terms of** the time we spend awake and **asleep**, **surfing** the internet and/or engaging with OTT platforms, playing video games and so on.

Then there are those who take **delight** in **following rigid** timetables, **unswervingly determined** and disciplined, marking time with the hands of the clock. Good, good. But there are also those of us who let time saunter, nay, even stand still, as we “stare as long as sheep or cows...” And see, “in broad daylight, streams full of stars, like skies at night...” Lazy? Oh no, just different, letting time do its thing as we do ours, guilt-free.

What is the spiritual view of time? This **popped up** in the search engine, among other pearls of **wisdom**: 'Chronos is quantity, while Kairos is quality. Chronos is our way of organising and attempting to control time, while Kairos is God's time.' I vote for **the latter**. [Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Parting** (adjective) – Valedictory, farewell, goodbye, final, last बिदाई

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

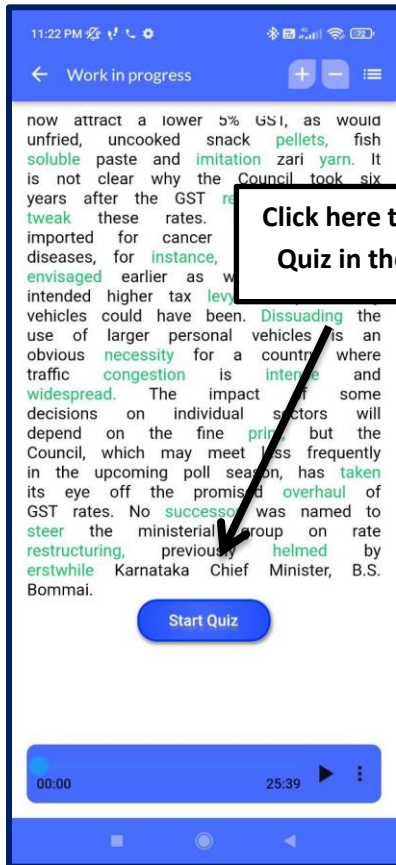
1. **Saunter** (verb) – Stroll, amble, wander, meander, roam टहलना, घूमना
2. **Stand** (verb) – Stay, halt, pause, remain, stop खड़ा होना, ठहरना
3. **Ironic** (adjective) – Satirical, sardonic, paradoxical, incongruous, mocking विडंबनापूर्ण
4. **Remark** (verb) – Comment, observe, mention, note, state टिप्पणी करना
5. **Chunky** (adjective) – Bulky, hefty, thick, solid, substantial मोटा, भारी
6. **Mumble** (verb) – Mutter, murmur, whisper, grumble, slur बुदबुदाना
7. **Stated** (adjective) – Declared, specified, expressed, affirmed, pronounced निर्दिष्ट, घोषित
8. **Look forward to** (phrase) – Anticipate, await, expect, hope for, long for उत्सुकता से इंतजार करना
9. **Concur** (verb) – Agree, assent, accord, consent, harmonize सहमत होना
10. **Sentiment** (noun) – Emotion, feeling, attitude, opinion, thought भावना
11. **Seem** (verb) – Appear, look, sound, feel, give the impression प्रतीत होना
12. **Nod** (verb) – Gesture, signal, bow, incline, acknowledge सिर हिलाना
13. **Assent** (noun) – Agreement, approval, consent, acceptance, concurrence सहमति
14. **Intrigue** (verb) – Fascinate, captivate, interest, engross, attract दिलचस्पी पैदा करना
15. **Conscious** (adjective) – Aware, mindful, alert, cognizant, attentive सचेत, जागरूक
16. **Renown** (verb) – Famous, celebrated, acclaimed, distinguished, noted प्रसिद्ध होना
17. **Stickler** (noun) – Perfectionist, pedant, disciplinarian, fanatic, zealot सख्त अनुशासनप्रिय
18. **Punctuality** (noun) – Timeliness, promptness, precision, exactness, reliability समय की पाबंदी
19. **Honour** (verb) – Respect, esteem, revere, venerate, uphold सम्मान करना
20. **Admit** (verb) – Acknowledge, confess, concede, accept, grant स्वीकार करना
21. **Slave** (noun) – Servant, bondsman, serf, drudge, toiler गुलाम
22. **Regimen** (noun) – Routine, schedule, system, program, plan दिनचर्या

23. **Ruminate** (verb) – Ponder, meditate, contemplate, reflect, muse विचार करना
24. **Bewitch** (verb) – Enchant, captivate, mesmerize, charm, fascinate मोहित करना
25. **Point out** (phrasal verb) – Indicate, highlight, mention, note, emphasize इंगित करना
26. **At hand** (phrase) – Nearby, close, available, accessible, imminent हाथ में, निकट
27. **Signal** (verb) – Indicate, gesture, signify, communicate, alert संकेत करना
28. **Circadian** (adjective) – Daily, 24-hour, rhythmic, biological, natural दैनिक लय
29. **Flout** (verb) – Defy, disregard, ignore, violate, scorn अवहेलना करना
30. **Moderation** (noun) – Restraint, temperance, balance, control, limitation संयम
31. **In terms of** (phrase) – Regarding, concerning, with respect to, in relation to, about के संदर्भ में
32. **Asleep** (adjective) – Sleeping, dormant, unconscious, napping, dozing सोया हुआ
33. **Surf** (verb) – Browse, navigate, scan, skim, explore इंटरनेट पर सरसरी नज़र डालना
34. **Delight** (noun) – Joy, pleasure, happiness, enjoyment, bliss आनंद
35. **Following** (preposition) – After, subsequent to, next, succeeding, ensuing के बाद
36. **Rigid** (adjective) – Strict, inflexible, stiff, firm, unyielding कठोर
37. **Unswervingly** (adverb) – Steadfastly, resolutely, firmly, determinedly, consistently दृढ़तापूर्वक
38. **Determined** (adjective) – Resolute, steadfast, firm, persistent, unwavering दृढ़निश्चयी
39. **Pop up** (phrasal verb) – Appear, emerge, surface, arise, show up अचानक दिखाई देना
40. **Wisdom** (noun) – Knowledge, insight, sagacity, prudence, understanding ज्ञान
41. **The latter** (noun) – Here it refers to 'Kairos'

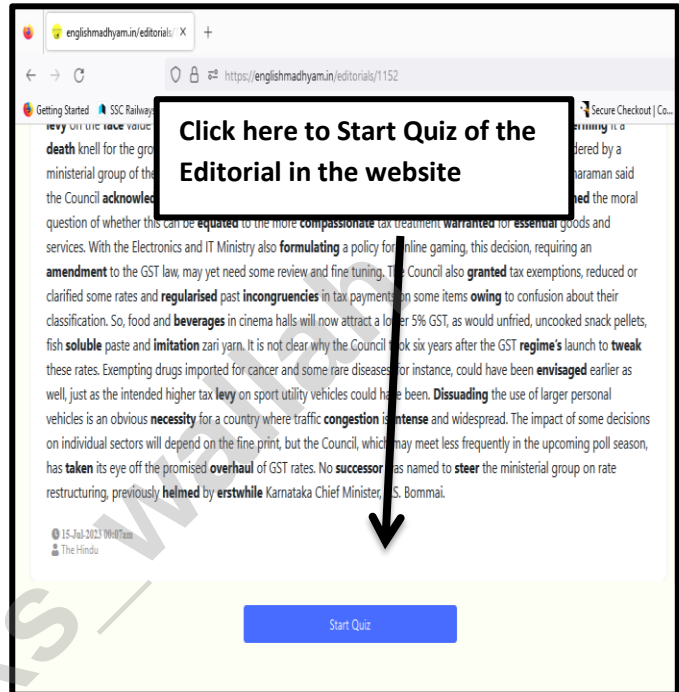
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Irony of Time in Retirement** – The retiring gentleman found it ironic to receive a wristwatch as a gift, as he looked forward to a life free from time constraints.
2. **Time and Work Routine** – Timekeeping is crucial in a working person's life, dictating schedules for office hours, meals, and commuting.
3. **Swiss Punctuality** – In Switzerland, time consciousness is a cultural trait, with every room having a clock and appointments expected to be honored with punctuality.
4. **Necessity of Time Management** – Time discipline is essential for meeting deadlines and maintaining daily routines like sleeping, eating, and working.
5. **Being Slaves to the Clock** – Modern life often makes people excessively bound to time, leaving little room for spontaneity and reflection.
6. **Balancing Doing and Being** – Buddhist perspectives emphasize that life should not be just about "doing" but also about "being," experiencing moments of stillness and presence.
7. **Traditional Rhythms of Time** – Earlier generations lived by natural time cycles—waking with the sun and resting at sunset, following the circadian rhythm.
8. **Artificial Control Over Time** – The invention of artificial light disrupted natural time cycles, extending activities beyond natural daylight hours.
9. **Moderation in Time Usage** – Just as moderation is essential in food and exercise, it is also necessary for managing screen time, entertainment, and wakefulness.
10. **Rigid vs. Flexible Approaches to Time** – Some people strictly adhere to rigid schedules, while others prefer a relaxed, unhurried approach to time.
11. **Embracing Stillness** – Some individuals find joy in allowing time to flow naturally, appreciating the world without guilt or hurry.
12. **Seeing Time Differently** – Instead of rushing through time, one can choose to be present, like observing nature deeply, akin to poetic reflections.
13. **Spiritual Perspective on Time** – The editorial introduces the distinction between *Chronos* (quantitative time, human-controlled) and *Kairos* (qualitative, divine time).
14. **Choosing Quality Over Quantity** – The writer favors *Kairos*, advocating for a focus on meaningful experiences over mechanical timekeeping.
15. **Conclusion: A Balanced Perspective on Time** – While time discipline is necessary, one must also embrace moments of freedom, contemplation, and simply "being."

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



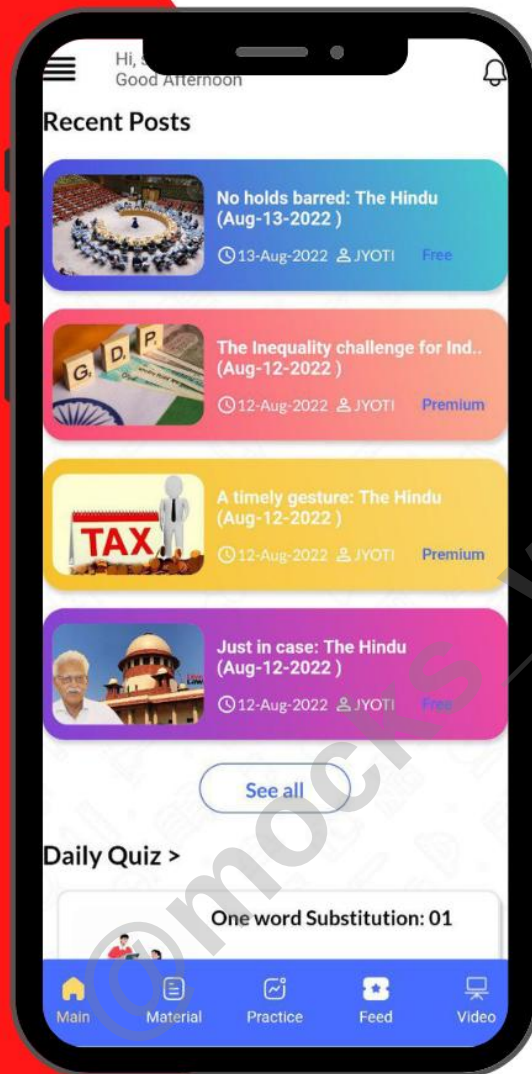
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